market and production base by using newer mechanisms and utilizing the existing ones like ASEAN Free Trade Areas (AFTA), ASEAN Framework Agreement on Services (AFAS) and ASEAN Investment Area (AIA).

- First Protocol to Amend the Protocol on Special Arrangements on Sensitive and Highly Sensitive Products, 3 September 2004.
- Protocol to Provide Special Consideration for Rice and Sugar, 23 August 2007.
- ASEAN Trade in Goods Agreement, Cha-am, Thailand, 26 February 2009.
- Annexes of the ASEAN Trade in Goods Agreement, Cha-am, Thailand, 26 February 2009.

All these are steps towards the creation of the ASEAN Economic Community which is the end-goal of economic integration measures as outlined in the ASEAN Vision 2020.

A positive step towards establishment of an ASEAN Community was taken at the Twelfth ASEAN Summit at Cebu, the Philippines. The leaders signed the **Cebu Declaration on the Acceleration of the Establishment of an ASEAN Community, by 2015**. The ASEAN Community as envisioned by the leaders is to comprise three pillars. The first one being the ASEAN Political-Security Community, the second one ASEAN Economic Community and the third ASEAN Socio-Cultural Community. The ASEAN Charter was adopted at the 13th ASEAN Summit in Singapore in November 2007 and it came into force in December 2008. The aim is to establish through the Charter, the legal and institutional framework of ASEAN.

Recent Issues and Concerns

The chief issues affecting peace and security include territorial and jurisdictional disputes in the South China Sea, self-determination for East Timor, nuclear proliferation in North East Asia and South Asia, weapons of mass destruction and the impact of globalization. At the turn of the twenty-first century, issues shifted to involve a more environmental prospective. The ASEAN member states became